



POLICY

Medication: Long-Acting Contraceptive

Scope (Worker):	NMHS Mental Health (MH) Staff: Clinical
Scope (Area):	NMHS Mental Health (MH) Areas

1. Aim

To provide NMHS MH clinical workers with the requirements for prescribing and management of long-acting contraceptive medication to ensure safe and effective treatment for patients of the service.

2. Background

Long-acting contraceptive medications used to temporarily prevent fertility for an extended period of time include: medroxyprogesterone IM depot injection, etonogestrel implant and levonorgestrel or copper intrauterine devices (IUD).

It does not include surgical sterilisation.

Long-acting contraceptive medication must only be prescribed at NMHS MH inpatient units in accordance with this policy. Patients of Community Mental Health Clinics must be referred to their GP or appropriate specialist service for treatment.

3. Risk

Non-compliance with this policy will impact on the following risk categories:

	☐	Quality of Patient Care	☒
Governance & Accountability	☒	Policy & Legislative Compliance	☒

Patients may suffer adverse outcomes related to long-acting contraception and may be treated without giving informed consent if it is not prescribed and managed in accordance with this policy.

4. Principles

Contraception is a medical treatment and the [WA Mental Health Act 2014](#) does not grant the ability for psychiatrists to prescribe contraceptives against the wishes of the patient.

When long-acting contraceptive medication is considered to be the best choice for a patient, the prescribing doctor must record the following in the patient's integrated progress notes:

- the reasons for the choice of treatment;
- that an appropriate gynaecological examination has taken place;
- any appropriate follow-up care must be specified.

5. Informed Consent

In accordance with the [WA Mental Health Act 2014](#) and the [WA Health Consent to Treatment Policy \(OD0657/16\)](#), informed consent must be recorded in the patient's integrated progress notes and must include:

- the date it was provided,
- who provided it, and
- if it was provided by someone other than the patient – the name and contact details of that person and their authority to make the treatment decision.

6. Compliance and Evaluation

- 100% of prescriptions of long- acting contraceptive medication to prevent fertility have the appropriate documentation in the patient's integrated progress notes
- This policy will be audited annually by NMHS MH Pharmacy

References
WA Mental Health Act 2014 WA Health Consent to Treatment Policy (OD0657/16) NMHS Women and Newborn Health Service: Clinical Practice Guideline - Contraception

Policy Sponsor	NMHS MH Chief Pharmacist				
Policy Contact	NMHS MH Chief Pharmacist				
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Approved by:	NMHS MH Drugs and Therapeutics Committee			Date:	01/08/2023
Endorsed by:	MHPHDS Executive Director			Date:	22/08/2023
NSQHS Standards Applicable:	☒  Std 1: Clinical Governance ☐  Std 2: Partnering with Consumers ☒  Std 4: Medication Safety		☐  Std 5: Comprehensive Care ☐  Std 6: Communicating for Safety		
National Standards for Mental Health Services	☒ Std 1: Rights and Responsibilities ☒ Std 8: Governance, leadership and management		☒ Std 10: Delivery of Care		
Chief Psychiatrist's Standards for Clinical Care:	Assessment, Care Planning, Consumer and Carer Involvement in Individual Care, Physical Health Care of Mental Health Consumers, Risk Assessment and Management				
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Document Version Control			
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19/07/2013	V1.0	MHEG: Chief Pharmacist	Meeting Minutes: 182/13
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3/12/2019	V2.0	NMHS MH DTC	Scheduled Review: DTC minutes
13/12/2019	V2.0	Chief Pharmacist	Scheduled review; new template
23/12/2019	V2.0	MHEG	Emails on W: drive
22/08/2023	V3.0	Chief Pharmacist	Scheduled review; new template; links updated

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